

End-of-Lease Bond-Back Checklist — Queensland

Protect your money — most bond disputes are avoidable with the right documentation.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice.

Section 1 — Understand How Your Bond Works

- ☐ [] **Know your bond is held by the Residential Tenancies Authority (RTA)**, not your landlord or agent directly.
- ☐ [] **Know the maximum bond amount.** A managing party cannot request more than **4 weeks' rent** as bond.
- ☐ [] **Understand bond is not a general maintenance fund** — it can only be claimed against for unpaid rent, cleaning to restore the property (allowing for fair wear and tear), or damage beyond fair wear and tear.
- ☐ [] **Check out the portable bond pilot if you're moving within South East Queensland.** A portable bond scheme launched as a pilot in January 2026, allowing eligible tenants to transfer their bond to a new property without finding a new bond payment upfront — check current eligibility with the RTA if this could apply to your move.

Section 2 — Before You Move Out

- ☐ [] **Locate your original entry condition report (Form 1a)** — your baseline for comparison.
- ☐ [] **Compare the property's current condition against that report**, room by room.
- ☐ [] **Clean thoroughly**, addressing anything genuinely beyond fair wear and tear.
- ☐ [] **Check every item on the original inventory** is present and in working order.
- ☐ [] **Settle any outstanding rent** before vacating.

Section 3 — At the Final Inspection

- ☐ [] **Complete the exit condition report (Form 14a)** together with your landlord/agent where possible.
- ☐ [] **Take your own timestamped photos** of every room after cleaning, regardless of whether the agent attends.
- ☐ [] **Keep every receipt** — cleaning, repairs, pest control — as evidence.

Section 4 — Claiming Your Bond

- ☐ [] **Lodge your side of the bond claim with the RTA** once you've vacated.
- ☐ [] **If both parties agree**, the RTA releases the bond according to the agreed split.
- ☐ [] **If there's a dispute**, either party can apply to the **Queensland Civil and Administrative Tribunal (QCAT)** for resolution.
- ☐ [] **Know what happens if a bond dispute is dismissed or withdrawn at QCAT** — the RTA will release the bond following the original decision, so understand the implications before withdrawing an application.

Section 5 — If There's a Dispute

- ☐ [] **Gather your evidence before applying to QCAT:** entry and exit condition reports, timestamped photos, receipts, and any correspondence.
- ☐ [] **Apply to QCAT** if you and your landlord can't agree — the tribunal will review evidence and make a binding decision.
- ☐ [] **Know landlords can seek compensation beyond the bond** if it doesn't cover their costs — this can also go to QCAT, so ensure your own records are thorough regardless of the bond amount itself.

Quick Reference — QLD Bond Process

ITEM	DETAIL
Bond holder	Residential Tenancies Authority (RTA)
Maximum bond	4 weeks' rent
Entry/exit condition reports	Form 1a (entry) and Form 14a (exit)
Dispute resolution	QCAT (Queensland Civil and Administrative Tribunal)
Portable bond pilot	South East Queensland, from January 2026 (check current eligibility)

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